

User Experience

User Experience (UX) focuses on how people feel and interact with a digital product, aiming to make those interactions simple, effective, and satisfying. A strong UX depends on thoughtful User Interface (UI) design, the visual and interactive layer that connects users to the system, and together they contribute to seamless Customer Experience (CX). Centered on empathy for user needs, validation through testing, and reuse of proven patterns, good UX design drives adoption, reduces rework, and enhances business value.

Key UX principles

The table below elaborates on the different UX principles:

Principle	Description	Practical outcome
Empathy	Understanding users' emotions, motivations, and challenges to design solutions that truly meet their needs.	- Observe users in their workflow, use empathy maps to identify their pain points. - Identify friction points to design intuitive and supportive experiences.
Validation	Testing ideas with real users to confirm that designs solve the right problems and work as intended.	- Conduct usability tests and gather feedback through low-cost prototypes. - Continuously refine designs based on real user insights.
Reuse	Leveraging existing patterns, components, and software to ensure consistency and efficiency.	- Reuse proven UI and UX elements to accelerate development and maintain consistency. - Reduce rework and costs by building existing validated designs.

User experience design process

Stage	Focus area	Common techniques
Early	Identify user needs and define the problem through research and observation.	- Interviews - Surveys - Empathy maps - Journey mapping
During	Create and test design concepts to validate ideas and improve usability.	- Prototyping - Usability testing - Wireframing - Heuristic evaluation

Later	Refine and finalize designs to ensure consistency, accessibility, and efficiency.	• A/B testing • Feedback analysis • Design reviews • Iterative updates
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Interface & interaction design leading practices

Interface design best practices:

- Keep interfaces simple and intuitive.
- Maintain consistency in layout, color, and typography.
- Provide system feedback (status, errors, confirmations).
- Design purposeful layouts – guide users naturally to complete tasks.
- Use color and texture strategically for clarity and focus.

Interaction design essentials:

- Define clear user interactions and outcomes.
- Give visual or behavioral cues before user actions.
- Anticipate and mitigate errors.
- Ensure accessibility and fast response times.
- Simplify for learnability and efficiency.

Now Experience: Introduction and benefits

The Now Experience framework was introduced to modernize the ServiceNow user interface and provide a seamless, consumer-grade experience. It enables developers to create consistent, responsive, and visually appealing interfaces across applications using reusable web components.

Next Experience UI framework allows you to:

- Create a single component to use in multiple places across your applications.
- Encapsulate the component's scope to prevent conflicts with other code.
- Customize components using properties, slots, and actions for flexible workspace use.
- Control APIs directly to enable faster updates and feature delivery.
- Maintain consistency and alignment across ServiceNow platform products.

Key elements of Now Experience

The key elements that make up the Now Experience framework include:

- **Now Design system:** Contains all the necessary elements for developers and designers to design, realize, and build products.
- **Components:** Components are the building blocks within the Design System for creating a user interface on the Next Experience Framework.
- **App Engine studio:** The App Engine Studio is a development tool for creators of varying skill levels to build applications on the Now Platform.
- **ServiceNow CLI:** The ServiceNow CLI is a command-line interface, external to ServiceNow, that allows developers to create, test, and upload components to a platform instance.

- **UI Builder:** The UI Builder is a “what you see is what you get” WYSIWYG web user interface builder, that allows developers to build pages for workspace and custom portal experiences. using components.

Now Experience components

Now Experience components provide the base components used to build custom user interfaces. Using the Design System, developers can select the building blocks of the Now Experience from pre-built components.

Benefits of Now Experience components:

- They are generic and flexible.
- They have built-in accessibility (WCAG 2.0).
- They are desktop- and mobile-web ready.
- They enable internationalization.

UX design considerations

As a CTA, maintain a form design checklist and supporting tools to ensure consistency, usability, and accessibility across variations:

- Logical form layout (this can be very subjective)
- Field data type
- Inclusion of appropriate fields with clear labels
- Tool tips to offer guidance
- Feedback to users through message options
- Effective use of color (including accessibility)
- Logical groupings of fields in sections
- Hints, annotations, and UI policies (make mandatory, hide, set read-only)